Zheyu Li

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Education

University of Maryland Aug. 2023 – Present
Doctor of Philosophy in Civil & Environmental Engineering

University of Maryland Aug. 2021 – Dec. 2023
Master of Science in Civil & Environmental Engineering

Chang' an University Sep. 2017 - Jul. 2021
Bachelor's in engineering (Major in Transportation)

Research Interests

Transportation Engineering; Optimization; Public Transportation System; Air Transportation.

Academic & Research Experience

Invited Presenter

Guest Presenter, ENCE 674 – Public Transportation Planning, University of Maryland, April 14, 2026
Guest Presenter, ENCE 672 – Regional Transportation Planning, University of Maryland, December 2, 2025
Guest Presenter, ENCE 674 – Public Transportation Planning, University of Maryland, April 22, 2025

Graduate Research Assistant (ADHS MTI Research Fellowship)

Transportation Research Fellow at Appalachian Regional Commission, Washington D.C.

Aug. 2022 – Present

- Updates the annual status report of the Appalachian Development Highway System (ADHS) by running financial reports from FHWA's FMIS5-P for ARC-funded projects and incorporating the data into 70 pages of text, figures, maps, and tables.
- Monitor monthly financial reports from FMIS for ARC-funded projects with the analysis of the data to identify trends, and actively collaborate with ARC budget staff to share insights and coordinate financial management efforts.
- Follow up with Local Access Road (LAR) projects in the EADHS portal for the LAR update function by the state DOTs, and monitor the status of the projects for close-out form and Basic Agency Monitoring Report (BAMR).

Undergraduate Thesis Researcher

Passenger Flow Forecast for Xi'an Metro Line 14, Chang'an University

Oct. 2020 – May. 2021

- Collected and cleaned daily passenger flow data for five existing Xi'an metro lines from official public sources.
- Developed regression-based forecasting models for Line 14 and compared projected passenger flows with those of existing metro lines.
- Examined the effects of COVID-19 on forecast results and system-level passenger flow patterns.

Transportation Statistic Analyst

City Transportation Research Center of Jinan, Shandong Province, China

Jul. 2019 – Aug. 2019

Helped finishing the documents of city introduction and the pictures of the road networks through TransCAD and Photoshop,

and collected the GPS location data through Baidu API by using Python.

Publications

Working Papers

1. **Li, Z.** and Schonfeld, P. "Joint Design of Rural Flexible-Route Bus Service and Request Stops for Low-Frequency Fixed-Route Buses," **to be submitted to *Transportation Research Part B: Methodological***
2. **Li. Z.**, Lei, Y.-Z., and Schonfeld, P. "Optimization of Runway Exits Locations Based on Fleet Mix and Operational Uncertainty," **to be submitted to *Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies***
3. **Li, Z.**, Lin, C.-Y., Babaee, S., Yu. T., and Schonfeld, P. "Multi-objective Runway Arrival Sequencing under Mixed Arrival and Departure Operations: A Simulation Study at SAN," **TSC Report 2026-1, Univ. of Maryland, College Park, Sept. 2026., under review at *Journal of Airport Management***
4. Chen. D., **Li. Z.**, Lei, Y.-Z., and Yang. X. T. "Roadway Connectivity Digital Twins: GIS State and Active Measurement Updates for Cellular Service Feasibility," **to be submitted to *IEEE GLOBECOM Workshop***
5. Chen. D., Lei, Y.-Z., **Li. Z.**, and Yang. X. T. "Decommissioning Rural Roadside Traveler Information Infrastructure: An Evidence-Based Framework for HAR and DMS in the Mobile Era," **under review at *Transportation Research Part A: Policy and Practice*, YTRA-D-26-03321**

Conference Papers and Presentations

1. **Li, Z.**, Wang, J. and Schonfeld, P. "A Planning Model for Flexible-route Delivery Optimization of Farm Products: A Case Study in Central Appalachia," **Lectern Session at 103rd Annual TRB Meeting, Jan. 2024., TRBAM-24-04252**
2. **Li, Z.**, Choi, Y.M. and Schonfeld, P. "Locations for Electric Truck Charging Stations and Impact of Battery Technology Improvement," **Poster Session at 104th Annual TRB Meeting, Jan. 2025., TRBAM-25-00308**
3. **Li, Z.** and Schonfeld, P. "Optimization of Runway Exits Locations Based on Fleet Mix and Operational Delays," **Lectern Session at 104th Annual TRB Meeting, Jan. 2025., TRBAM-25-03220**
4. **Li, Z.** and Schonfeld, P. "Hybrid Scheduling and Routing for Rural Transit with Flexible and Fixed-Route Integration," **Lectern Session at 105th Annual TRB Meeting, Jan. 2026., TRBAM-26-02208**
5. **Li, Z.**, Wang, J. and Schonfeld, P. "A Performance Evaluation Framework for Rural Access Road Investments: From Application Estimates to Project Completion," **Poster Session at 106th Annual TRB Meeting, TRBAM-27-03319**
6. **Li, Z.** and Schonfeld, P. "Joint Design of Rural Flexible-Route Bus Service and Request Stops for Low-Frequency Fixed-Route Buses," **Poster Session at 106th Annual TRB Meeting, TRBAM-27-03568**
7. Chen. D., Lei, Y.-Z., **Li. Z.**, and Yang. X. T. "Decommissioning Rural Roadside Traveler Information Infrastructure: An Evidence-Based Framework for HAR and DMS in the Mobile Era," **Poster Session at 106th Annual TRB Meeting, TRBAM-27-04695**

Journal Articles

1. **Li, Z.**, Choi, Y.M., and Schonfeld, P. "Strategic Location Planning for Electric Truck Charging Stations using Truck Trajectory Data Improvement," accepted for the ***Transportation Research Record***, October 2025, https://doi.org/10.1177/03611981251364835
2. **Li, Z.** and Schonfeld, P. "Hybrid Scheduling and Routing for Rural Transit with Flexible and Fixed-Route Integration," accepted for the ***Transportation Research Record***, July 2026, https://doi.org/10.1177/03611981261480104

Service to the profession

Reviewer for Transportation Research Record, Transportation Research Board Annual Meeting